Anupam Chugh

Product Manager and Product Owner | Mobile Apps (iOS and Android) | On-device AI
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SUMMARY

Product manager and product owner who has built mobile apps on iOS and Android for 10+ years. I take products from idea to release: user research, roadmaps and backlog prioritisation, analytics, UAT and beta rounds, and App Store delivery, keeping engineering, design, support and business stakeholders aligned when priorities clash. I steadied a struggling Android team at Agricx, built delivery apps with product, web and support teams at MOBEY, grew Better Programming into Medium's largest programming publication, and since 2024 own 19 App Store apps at my studio, Alcor, several built on on-device AI.

SKILLS

Product management: Product discovery and user research, roadmaps, backlog grooming and prioritisation, user stories and acceptance criteria, analytics and KPIs (App Store Connect, Medium stats), UAT and TestFlight beta rounds, release planning.
Stakeholders and teams: Stakeholder management, conflict management, cross-functional work with engineering, design, web, ML and support, team mentoring, editorial strategy.
Mobile: Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit, Kotlin, Java, Android, SwiftData, CloudKit, MapKit, AVFoundation, RealityKit, App Intents.
AI and vision: Apple Foundation Models, Core ML, Vision, OpenCV, model evaluation, MCP, agent-assisted development.
Quality: XCTest, Swift Testing, UI test automation, simulator screenshot pipelines, App Store release checks.

EXPERIENCE

Product Owner | Alcor, independent app studio (getalcor.com) 2024–present

- Product owner and product manager for 19 apps live on the App Store, each taken from idea to release myself: I set the roadmap, write and prioritise the backlog with acceptance criteria, run TestFlight beta rounds as user acceptance testing, read App Store analytics and crash reports to decide the next release, and handle App Review. In development for a client: **MeAmi Stays**, a booking assistant that quotes only what its tools return.
- **Wearover:** pick a photo and a look, or a room and a style; the clothes, hair or decor change while your face and space stay true. Built on-device with Apple Foundation Models and Vision, so photos never leave the phone. Same idea Meta later brought to WhatsApp with Muse Image.
- **Breakline:** a coach for surfing, the gym and five more sports that reads your pose from your own clips and measures how you move, frame by frame. Measurements only, never a score, and nothing is uploaded. Gym sets get spotted and tracked, and the next release replays your move on a 3D humanoid version of you.
- **Orbits:** turn saved places into a plan for today or a meetup; everyone swipes and the plan is what you all liked. SwiftUI, SwiftData, MapKit, CloudKit and Multipeer. Shipped 12 releases before WhatsApp launched Events Home.
- **TradeShot and Glint** (in development): trading made understandable for anyone. Plain-language answers instead of jargon, practice trades and market games like Flickpot to learn before risking money, and trade ideas based on your own goals. Nothing is ever traded without your say.
- **TickNote** (in development): market updates sent as messages you review first, with each one's delivery tracked so nothing goes out twice.
- **Landfall** (in development): tell your work story once, then turn it into a résumé where every line traces back to your own words. **DocPolish:** straighten and clean passports, IDs and receipts, all on the phone.
- For play: Checkmate Academy for learning chess; Flickpot, a coin-flicking game on green felt where every coin is a market ticker, dreamed up during a board-game night; Feedloom with Threadmark, a calm reader that saves my favourite feeds and traces a writer's work across the web.

Managing Editor | Better Programming, Medium 2021–2023

- Built internal tools to scout writers and stories: MediumRSS followed 100+ Medium topics and tracked each writer's style and publishing pattern over time, so I could pick the writers and stories most likely to grow the publication's readers and subscribers. Coffee Bytes, a newsletter, grew out of it.
- Took over Better Programming from my predecessor, then consolidated and grew it into Medium's largest programming publication: lifetime pageviews rose from 50M to 150M, peaking near 6M a month, across 4,600 authors. Medium put the publication on hiatus after I left.
- Used pageview and reader data to decide which topics and writers to commission; managed 4,600 authors and Medium's editorial staff, and settled disagreements over edits and rejections so strong writers stayed.
- Managed engineer-writers across the globe, from a 10-year-old to people in their 70s learning Java: mentored and edited them, and tracked each writer's growth over time to decide whom to develop and feature.

- Built tools for editors and managers, including review tools that extend the ones my predecessor, Zack Shapiro, started, so weak submissions were filtered out early.

Mobile Developer (Contract) | Aged Care Decisions, Australia (remote) 2020–2021
- Built server-driven, white-labelled iOS and Android apps for Australia's largest aged care placement service: one codebase, several vendor apps the web team could ship.

Android Team Lead and iOS Developer | Agricx 2018–2019
- Took over a messy Android codebase and team, and left both in better shape by the end: cleaner code, steadier releases and engineers I mentored along the way.
- Taught myself iOS for its fluid animations, then built the company's entire iOS app end to end, through to TestFlight: count, size and grade a crop sample with OpenCV, ArUco markers and AVFoundation (gallery).
- Worked with the ML and web teams to agree what could run on the device; moved early experiments onto the phone with Core ML while their models were being fine-tuned.

Lead Android Developer | MOBEY 2015–2017
- Built the customer and driver Android apps for on-demand delivery of food, groceries and alcohol on the Gold Coast, working daily with product managers, web developers and customer support to turn their requirements into releases (gallery).
- Covered the order-to-delivery journey: driver go-online, receipt capture, proof of delivery and tipping; helped redesign the iOS apps.
- When Uber sent a legal notice over the original name, MUBER, a week before launch, rebranded the entire Android app in days.
- Shipped the very last iOS update before the company shut down in 2017: a one-line display text change, so the final word in the app was mine.

Android Developer and Technical Writer | JournalDev 2015–2019
- Built the first JournalDev Android app (4.4 stars, 10K+ downloads) and wrote Android, Java and Kotlin tutorials; JournalDev was later acquired by DigitalOcean (gallery).

Co-founder | Dourier 2015
- Built a courier and print-delivery MVP with friends to learn how a startup breaks before joining one. Shipped it, learned what we needed, and let it go.

Software Engineering Intern | Syniverse 2014
- Integrated a Spring Batch application into the team's financial clearing product; offered a pre-placement job and turned it down to build my own apps.

EDUCATION

Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS Pilani), Hyderabad Campus 2011–2015
B.E., Computer Science

OPEN SOURCE AND TOOLS

- **AlcorKit** (grew out of ChughyFMStack): my apps' shared toolkit for on-device AI, checking every number and name in an AI answer against its source, and in-app feedback.
- **Deckloom:** a SwiftUI package for cards you can stack, swipe, fan out like a hand or open full screen, with no dependencies.
- **SimLanes:** keeps testing honest across many apps by proving the right app is running before any screenshot is trusted.
- **chughy-skills:** safety checks a coding assistant runs before an App Store upload, such as blocking hidden switches left in a release.
- **Pastport:** ask your Safari history in plain words to find a page again or spot the ideas you keep coming back to. Runs privately on your Mac.
- **iowncode:** 900+ GitHub stars. Years of iOS, Core ML, Vision and AR experiments with tutorials, including a card stack you swipe with a thumbs-up instead of a finger.

WRITING

- Wrote for engineers in three voices: tutorials (iOSDevie), analysis (The Big Tech) and satire (Humor Bytes). "Apple Is Killing a Billion Dollar Industry" passed 500K views and reached the Hacker News front page.

HOW I BUILD

- I think about user flows like film scenes: setup, tension, payoff.
- I keep my own copy: if you don't own the ground, you're decorating someone else's house.
- I build curious things until one becomes useful. The hand-gesture card stack from 2020 became the swipe in Orbits.